African Data Ethics: Centering African Values in Artificial Intelligence Resource Page

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Background

Many global discussions around **AI ethics** are dominated by **Western perspectives**, often overlooking the **cultural, political,** and **historical** contexts of other regions. This site addresses the **lack** of **accessible resources** on **African approaches to AI and data ethics**. By centering **African values** like communalism, justice, and self-determination, it provides a platform for **ethical frameworks rooted in African contexts** frameworks that have long been **excluded from mainstream** discourse. This initiative supports more **equitable** and **representative** conversations about how **AI** should be **developed and used.**

Research Questions

RQ1: What are the key themes of African AI ethics today, and how are they likely to evolve in the future?
RQ2: How can we promote the usability of African AI ethics frameworks by AI practitioners?

Research Process

1) Reading research papers (20+)
2) Writing Annotated Bibliography
3) Designing website
4) Implementing website
5) User Testing
6) Final Website

Website QR Code and URL

Reading Takeaways

- Current **AI systems ignore and marginalize** African voices, systems, and **ethics frameworks - "algorithmic colonialism"** that mirrors **historical exploitation.**
- **African philosophies** emphasize relationality, community, and human dignity, which **challenge Western individualistic** approaches
- **Call for intersectionality**, to challenge marginalization within African AI ethics
- AI development should empower African nations as creators, and not just consumers, of AI technologies

Website Design Goals

- Provide accessible, well-researched information about African AI ethics
- Center African values like communalism, justice, self-determination, and decolonial thinking.
- Support conversations and learning around equity, power, and fairness in the AI and data space

Introduction Page


African Data Ethics

DATA ——— ETHICS FRAMEWORK

OVERVIEW/PURPOSE

Creating a website with information about African AI ethics for anybody who is interested in learning more about it.

African Data Ethics is a public resource dedicated to introducing and exploring African perspectives on artificial intelligence (AI) and data ethics. This site is for anyone interested in learning more about how ethical frameworks rooted in African contexts can shape the development, governance, and impact of AI technologies across the continent and globally.

We aim to:

- Provide accessible, well-researched information about African AI ethics
- Center African values like communalism, justice, self-determination, and decolonial thinking
- Support conversations and learning around equity, power, and fairness in the AI and data space

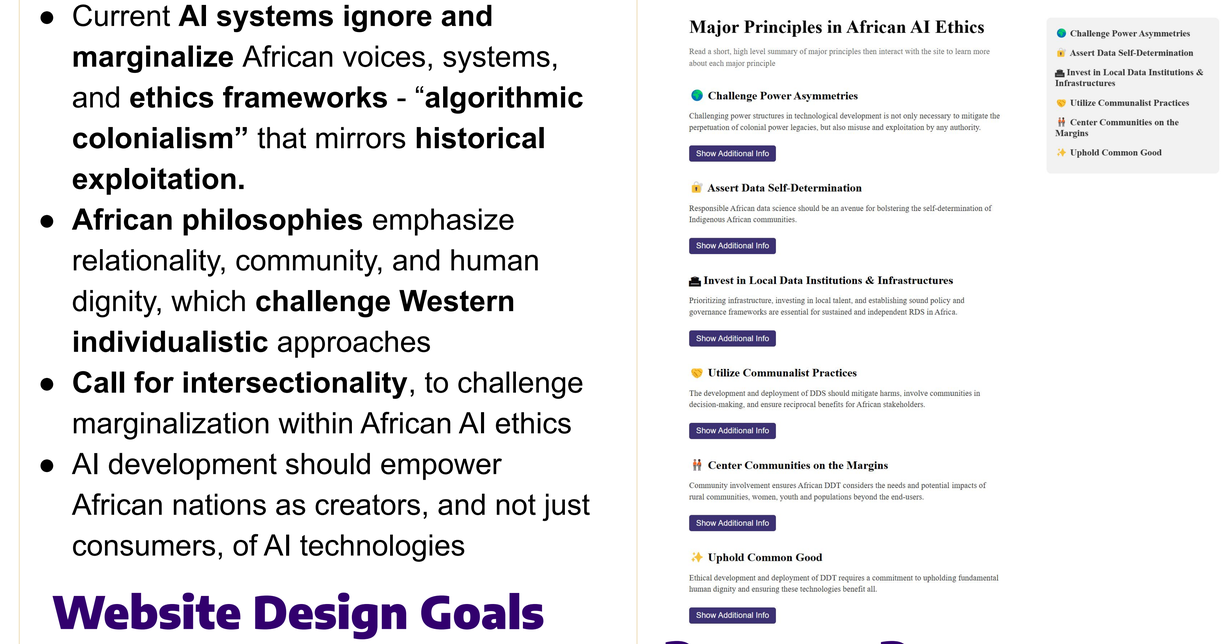
GOALS:

Our main goal is to spread awareness and deepen understanding of African AI ethics.

Through this site, we hope to:

- Share ethical principles, values, and resources
- Encourage inclusive conversations in the tech and policy world
- Empower communities with knowledge that reflects their experiences and priorities

Values Page


Major Principles in African AI Ethics

Read a short, high level summary of major principles then interact with the site to learn more about each major principle

🌏 Challenge Power Asymmetries

Challenging power structures in technological development is not only necessary to mitigate the perpetuation of colonial power legacies, but also misuse and exploitation by any authority.

Show Additional Info

🔐 Assert Data Self-Determination

Responsible African data science should be an avenue for bolstering the self-determination of Indigenous African communities.

Show Additional Info

🏦 Invest in Local Data Institutions & Infrastructures

Prioritizing infrastructure, investing in local talent, and establishing sound policy and governance frameworks are essential for sustained and independent RDS in Africa.

Show Additional Info

🤝 Utilize Communalist Practices

The development and deployment of DDS should mitigate harms, involve communities in decision-making, and ensure reciprocal benefits for African stakeholders.

Show Additional Info

🌏 Challenge Power Asymmetries

🔐 Assert Data Self-Determination

🏦 Invest in Local Data Institutions & Infrastructures

🤝 Utilize Communalist Practices

👫 Center Communities on the Margins

✨ Uphold Common Good

👫 Center Communities on the Margins

Community involvement ensures African DDT considers the needs and potential impacts of rural communities, women, youth and populations beyond the end-users.

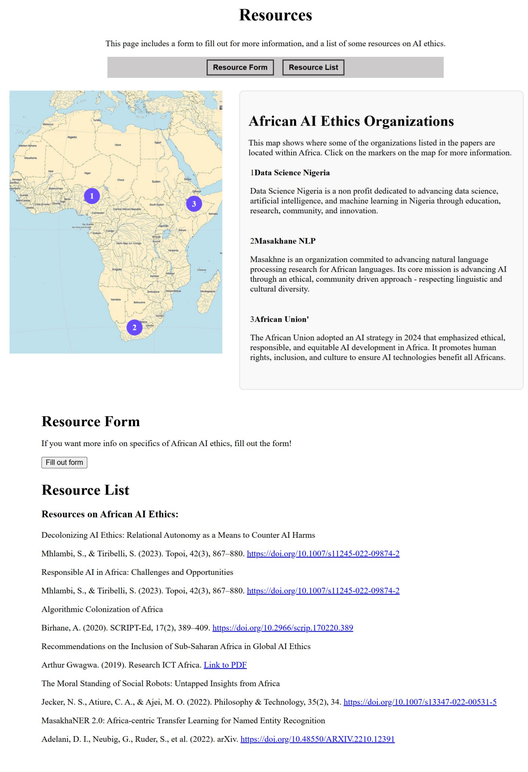
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✨ Uphold Common Good

Ethical development and deployment of DDT requires a commitment to upholding fundamental human dignity and ensuring these technologies benefit all.

Show Additional Info

Resource Page


Resources

This page includes a form to fill out for more information, and a list of some resources on AI ethics.

Resource Form | Resource List

African AI Ethics Organizations

This map shows where some of the organizations listed in the papers are located within Africa. Click on the markers on the map for more information.

1Data Science Nigeria

Data Science Nigeria is a non profit dedicated to advancing data science, artificial intelligence, and machine learning in Nigeria through education, research, community, and innovation.

2Masakhane NLP

Masakhne is an organization commited to advancing natural language processing research for African languages. Its core mission is advancing AI through an ethical, community driven approach - respecting linguistic and cultural diversity.

3African Union'

The African Union adopted an AI strategy in 2024 that emphasized ethical, responsible, and equitable AI development in Africa. It promotes human rights, inclusion, and culture to ensure AI technologies benefit all Africans.

Resource Form

If you want more info on specifics of African AI ethics, fill out the form!

Fill out form

Resource List

Resources on African AI Ethics:

Decolonizing AI Ethics: Relational Autonomy as a Means to Counter AI Harms

Mhlambi, S., & Tiribelli, S. (2023). Topoi, 42(3), 867–880. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11245-022-09874-2

Responsible AI in Africa: Challenges and Opportunities

Mhlambi, S., & Tiribelli, S. (2023). Topoi, 42(3), 867–880. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11245-022-09874-2

Algorithmic Colonization of Africa

Birhane, A. (2020). SCRIPT-Ed, 17(2), 389–409. https://doi.org/10.2966/scrip.170220.389

Recommendations on the Inclusion of Sub-Saharan Africa in Global AI Ethics

Arthur Gwagwa. (2019). Research ICT Africa. Link to PDF

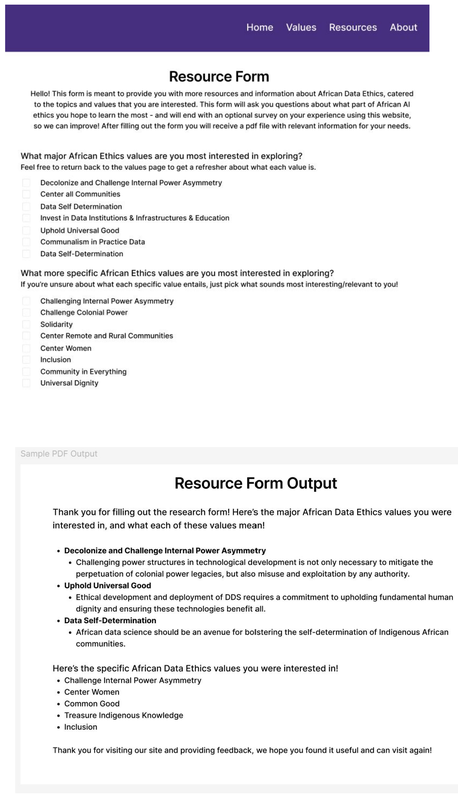
The Moral Standing of Social Robots: Untapped Insights from Africa

Jecker, N. S., Atiure, C. A., & Ajei, M. O. (2022). Philosophy & Technology, 35(2), 34. https://doi.org/10.1007/s13347-022-00531-5

MasakhaNER 2.0: Africa-centric Transfer Learning for Named Entity Recognition

Adelani, D. I., Neubig, G., Ruder, S., et al. (2022). arXiv. https://doi.org/10.48550/ARXIV.2210.12391

Resource Form


Home Values Resources About

Resource Form

Hello! This form is meant to provide you with more resources and information about African Data Ethics, catered to the topics and values that you are interested. This form will ask you questions about what part of African AI ethics you hope to learn the most - and will end with an optional survey on your experience using this website, so we can improve! After filling out the form you will receive a pdf file with relevant information for your needs.

What major African Ethics values are you most interested in exploring?
Feel free to return back to the values page to get a refresher about what each value is.

- [ ] Decolonize and Challenge Internal Power Asymmetry
- [ ] Center all Communities
- [ ] Data Self Determination
- [ ] Invest in Data Institutions & Infrastructures & Education
- [ ] Uphold Universal Good
- [ ] Communalism in Practice Data
- [ ] Data Self-Determination

What more specific African Ethics values are you most interested in exploring?
If you're unsure about what each specific value entails, just pick what sounds most interesting/relevant to you!

- [ ] Challenging Internal Power Asymmetry
- [ ] Challenge Colonial Power
- [ ] Solidarity
- [ ] Center Remote and Rural Communities
- [ ] Center Women
- [ ] Inclusion
- [ ] Community in Everything
- [ ] Universal Dignity

Sample PDF Output

Resource Form Output

Thank you for filling out the research form! Here's the major African Data Ethics values you were interested in, and what each of these values mean!

- **Decolonize and Challenge Internal Power Asymmetry**
  - Challenging power structures in technological development is not only necessary to mitigate the perpetuation of colonial power legacies, but also misuse and exploitation by any authority.
- **Uphold Universal Good**
  - Ethical development and deployment of DDS requires a commitment to upholding fundamental human dignity and ensuring these technologies benefit all.
- **Data Self-Determination**
  - African data science should be an avenue for bolstering the self-determination of Indigenous African communities.

Here's the specific African Data Ethics values you were interested in!

- Challenge Internal Power Asymmetry
- Center Women
- Common Good
- Treasure Indigenous Knowledge
- Inclusion

Thank you for visiting our site and providing feedback, we hope you found it useful and can visit again!

Contribution

- Decolonizes the conversation on AI ethics
- Highlights African expertise, not just Western frameworks
- Makes African AI ethics accessible for students, researchers, and the public

What's Next?

- Expanding the website - adding new features and improving existing ones
- Doing more research on AI Ethics
- Promoting the website to AI practitioners

Acknowledgement

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